How to Explain Sex to a Child

By Ellen Degeneres

Hey, Debbie, this is Ellen. Thanks for saying that you'd watch my house while I'm gone next week. I know you said you would water the plants, bring in the mail, and turn some lights on so that it looks like somebody is home. But if it's not too much of an imposition, could you also make sure that the mobile over the crib isn't tangled? Otherwise, the baby is just going to get bored. I never knew having a kid was so much responsibility! Bye bye.

INTRODUCTION

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I'm just joking. I don't have a baby. I want to have a child. I really do. I think about it every day – and every day I change my mind. I think that part of my dilemma is that even though I want to have a baby, I don't want to HAVE the baby. I can't imagine HAVING the baby. Giving birth is just so much pain. I know it's a beautiful child you end up with. I'm aware of that. But if I want a new washer and dryer, I wouldn't necessarily want to HAVE a new washer and dryer, if you know what I mean (and if you don't, I really don't care to explain it in any more detail).

I don't need a baby growing inside of me for nine months either. I know that a woman glows when she's pregnant, and that sounds neat. But, I can get a pretty good glow by enjoying a steam bath followed by some assorted skin creams. The thing that I don't understand most is when a pregnant woman joyfully talks about feeling her baby kick. To me, getting kicked isn't as big a thrill as others make it out to be. I've never liked getting kicked from the outside, why would I feel any

different about an inside kick?

But I would like to have a child. So, one day I'd like to adopt a baby who needs a loving home and be a mother who will adore him or her and teach it important things. I think I'd make a great mother. I'm great with kids. I know this because I'm the godmother to a precious little two- or five-year-old boy or girls (I'm not sure of the specifics). She (if it's a girl) or he (if it's not a girl) would always have to wear a helmet (even if it's just to each cereal; those spoons can be mighty dangerous!); would be on one of those protective leashes until, at least, senior year of high school; and would, in general, be raised like people raise veal – confined to a crate by itself somewhere.

I think my best quality as a mother would be the ability to communicate complex ideas simply. I think all parents dread the old "How are babies made" question. I know my parents had a problem explaining this to me.

"Mommy, Daddy – how are babies made?"

"Well Ellen honey, there's an egg."

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"Like a chicken egg?"

"No, smaller."

"Like a robin's egg?"

"No, much smaller – it's very small. And Daddy gives Mommy . . . Well, there's a Pappa Bear and a Mama Bear and the Mamma Bear has the baby in her tummy – "

"So I grew in a bear's stomach?"

"No, but if you were a bear you would've."

"But I'm not a bear?"

"No, you're a little girl."

"So, where did I grow?"

"In Mommy's tummy."

"How did I get there?"

"Daddy gave her special sauce."

"Like McDonald's?"

"Who knows? Maybe."

"How did he give it to her? In a hamburger?"

"Okay. Yes."

"I like hamburgers. God night."

"Good night, sleep tight."

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I know that I could do a much better job answering that question than my parents. Other people sense this too. In fact, hardly a day goes by when somebody doesn't ask me, "Ellen, how can I explain sex to my children?" And the more children there are, the more explaining about sex there is to be done.

By sex I mean, of course . . . sex. You know what I'm saying. There are many different types of sex, but for the purpose of this explanation I'm just talking about . . . you know, sex. In other words, you might have two consenting adults, a coconut, a pound of confetti, and a very thirsty yak. What they do may be very beautiful and spiritual and fulfilling, but it's not necessarily something you'd care to explain to a child. Okay, I think we've defined our terms, so let's get on with the explanation.

What you've got to do is just explain sex simply and to the point. You just say, "When you get older you're going to meet somebody that you really, really, really like. Well, if you're lucky you're going to like that

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person. Maybe you don't even like 'em a lot, but at least they don't bug you too much.

Maybe it's better to be a bit more allegorical. Tell a little story. You could say that there's a Papa Bear and a Mama Bear. And the Mama Bear says, "Where is that Papa Bear? He hasn't been home in a long time. He says he's working late at the pretzel factory, but I don't believe that lying grizzly." So she hires another bear to follow the Pap Bear – a Detective Bear (or, if you prefer, a detective goat – don't be afraid to add your own spin to the story).

Well, the Detective Bear shadows the Papa Bear for a week. Then he tells the Mama Bear that every night, after work, Papa Bear goes to the same hotel room in the Poconos. Well, Mama Bear decides that she's going to give Papa Bear a big surprise. So she goes to the hotel, kicks down the door, and there in the hear-shaped tub, sipping champagne, as naked as the day they were born are . . . . No, this isn't a good way either.

There's is a big fat queen bee, and she likes her

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honey. So she's in her have and all these male bees are just buzzing around saying, "Oooo baby, I feel lucky tonight."

Or you take a big tub of butter, some milk, tow or thee eggs, a dash of vanilla . . . No, I'm sorry, that's not sex, that's my recipe for French toast. At least I hope that's not sex.

You know, I think the best idea is just to let the child watch cable TV.

So in conclusion, that's how I would talk to a child about sex. I sincerely hope that I've been of help. Excuse me, but I've got to go out for a short walk. All of a sudden it has gotten very hot in here, and I've developed a craving for French toast!

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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